DECLASSIFIED
E. O. 11652, Sec. 3(E) and 5(D) or (E)
Dept. of State letter, Aug. 5, 1973
By NLT-HC, NARS Date 7-20-76

Generalissimo Chiang to President Roosevelt,
Telegram dated at Chungking, Szechuan, December 17, 1943
(Lt. Gen. Joseph W. Stilwell Radios, Personal File, Book 5,
Item 1529, located in Historical Records Section, Adjutant
General's Office, Department of the Army, The Pentagon)

My telegram of December 10th[1] must have reached you by this time. I have discussed with General Stilwell the proposed change in the plan of campaign and have come to the following conclusions: In case the original plan of concentrating warships and transports for landing troops cannot be completely carried out, it would be better to defer the amphibious all-out offensive till November next as you suggested so that the enemy in Burma may be annihilated once and for all. In the meantime preparations for an offensive against Burma next spring should proceed at full speed as originally planned, thus enabling us to launch an attack on land at any moment which is deemed favorable, or at any time before next autumn if a sufficient number of warships and transports can be concentrated to effect a grand scale landing on the enemy's flanks, without waiting till the autumn of next year. In this way the Burma front might be liquidated sooner than one could anticipate. I have decided to accept your suggestion that the general offensive against Burma should be postponed to November next or sooner if the original amphibious operation could be launched. At the same time I cannot but reiterate that in the intervening period of one year during which there will be little hope of re-opening the Burma Road the China theater of war will be in a most critical situation. I therefore earnestly ask you to do all in your power to accede to my request for financial assistance and for an increase of air force and air transportation as stated in my telegram of December 10th, in the hope that the danger to the China theater may be removed and the drawbacks in the strategy against Japan remedied in accordance with your consistent friendly policy of rendering assistance to China. Awaiting an early reply.

---

[1]Probably telegram of December 8 is intended. See DOCUMENT Q, p. C-67.